

CR-001 — Candidate Application Retraction

Request: “Candidates should be able to retract a submitted application.”

Status: Mock Approved with conditions

Priority: Medium

1. Current Baseline

FR-CAN-006 allows submission and FR-CAN-007 allows status tracking. The baseline provides no candidate-initiated retraction after submission. BR-005 contains no Retracted status.

2. Requested Change

Add **FR-CAN-008:** *The system shall allow an authenticated candidate to retract their own application while its status is Submitted or Under Review.*

Add **BR-006:** A candidate may retract only their own application when status is Submitted or Under Review. Retraction is final in the MVP; the candidate cannot restore that application or submit a second application for the same job without a separate approved change.

Amend **BR-005** to include `Retracted` as a terminal application status.

3. Business Rationale

Candidates may apply in error or decide not to continue. A controlled retraction improves candidate self-service and gives recruiters an accurate applicant pool without deleting historical records.

4. Impact Analysis

Dimension	Impact
Scope	Adds candidate UI action, eligibility rule, new status, API/service logic, recruiter visibility, audit event, tests, SRS/SDD/manual updates.
Schedule	Estimated +5 SP. Fits Sprint 4 only if 5 SP of lower-priority work is removed or velocity has capacity; otherwise release moves by up to ~2–3 working days.
Cost/Effort	No new license cost. Incremental team effort estimated at ~5 SP; hours are not used as the primary estimate.
Risk	Medium. Key risks: unauthorized retraction, status race condition, recruiter misunderstanding, accidental data deletion. Mitigate with ownership checks, allowed-state validation, audit trail, soft status transition, tests.

5. Affected Requirements / RTM

Requirement	Change	RTM Reference
FR-CAN-007	Candidate list must display Retracted status	JRP-RTM.xlsx

FR-REC-003	Applicant list must show retracted records/status	JRP-RTM.xlsx
FR-REC-004	Applicant details must show retraction status/time	JRP-RTM.xlsx
NFR-005	Retraction must create an audit event	JRP-RTM.xlsx
BR-005	Add Retracted terminal status	SRS
FR-CAN-008	New requirement: candidate retracts eligible own application	JRP-RTM.xlsx
BR-006	New eligibility/finality rule	SRS

6. Design and Test Impact

- Add `Retracted` status and `retracted\_at` timestamp to Application design.
- Add candidate ****Retract Application**** action with confirmation dialog only for Submitted/Under Review.
- Add `POST /api/applications/{id}/retract`; service verifies authenticated ownership and eligible state.
- Preserve record; do not hard-delete application.
- Add audit event `APPLICATION\_RETRACTED`.
- Test authorized/unauthorized user, each eligible/ineligible status, repeat request, recruiter visibility, audit entry, and candidate manual steps.

7. Mock Approval Workflow

1. Candidate feedback/request logged as CR-001.
2. BA validates need and completes impact/RTM analysis.
3. Technical Lead reviews feasibility and risks.
4. QA reviews test impact.
5. Product Owner compares value against Sprint 4 capacity.
6. Sponsor/Product Owner approves with condition: swap out an equivalent 5 SP lower-priority item if capacity is full.
7. BA updates SRS/RTM/backlog baseline.
8. Team implements and tests.
9. BA verifies user manual and traceability; Product Owner accepts.
10. CR is closed with implementation evidence.

8. How This Prevents Scope Creep

The feature is not added informally. The CR records the business rationale, identifies every affected requirement and artifact, estimates delivery impact, exposes risks, requires an explicit priority trade-off and approval, and updates the baseline only after approval. This keeps the team from silently absorbing extra work while preserving traceability from request to implementation and test.